

Part 3 – Reflection Presentation

Innovative Unit Plan: Minecraft Education Coding FUNdamentals

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- My innovative unit plan is a **4-lesson Grade 4 inclusive computer science unit** for Pine Brook's IGNITE rotation.
- I used **Minecraft Education Coding FUNdamentals** to teach sequencing, debugging, and algorithmic thinking.
- In placement, I kept seeing students get stuck on things like **menu clicks, sign-in, reading NPC directions, and managing multi-step agent code.**
- My main design goal was to make sure students were not labeled as “**bad at coding**” when the real barrier might be reading load, navigation, language, or executive functioning.
- So the unit was built to separate **access barriers** from **actual computational thinking.**

Strategies I used in the unit plan

- **Started with placement evidence:** I used Pine Brook observations to identify real barriers students face in digital lessons.
- **Designed Tier 1 first:** predictable routine, explicit modeling, visual supports, partner structure, and low-stakes debugging norms.
- **Made the goal visible:** in one lesson, many students were stuck because they did not understand that **both gold plates had to be activated at the same time**. That pushed me to make task goals and success criteria much clearer in the unit.
- **Added targeted scaffolds:** chunking directions, vocabulary support, counting steps with students, and proximity support when needed.
- **Used multi-source assessment:** planning sheets, teacher observation, student explanation, completed code, and reflection — not just task completion.

These strategies were meant to keep rigor high while making participation and understanding more visible.

Learning that shaped this plan

- **Karten and MTSS:** inclusion is not just placement; it is designing support into instruction from the start.
- **UDL thinking:** students need multiple ways to access content, show learning, and stay engaged.
- **Assessment course learning:** one score or one product never tells the full story of what a student knows.
- Placement made this real for me: some students needed a hint like “your agent can float” or “rename run to one” not because they lacked ideas, but because the task load was hiding their thinking.
- **My own lens:** as a neurodivergent learner, I wanted to build a unit that does not confuse speed, compliance, or polished output with intelligence.

Key shift in my thinking

Inclusive planning is not adding accommodations at the end; it is building a lesson so more students can show what they know from the beginning.

- This assignment helped me move from **general beliefs about inclusion** to **specific instructional decisions**.
- It made me think more carefully about how a lesson can look engaging on paper but still hide barriers for neurodivergent and CLD learners.
- It also pushed me to connect theory to practice: Pine Brook observations, course readings, and my own teaching values all had to work together.
- The biggest lesson for me was that students often need support with the **entry into the task**, not just the concept itself.
- If I revise this unit again, I want to use even more implementation data to see which supports truly improved access and which need adjustment.

- Start with **learner variability**, not the myth of an average student.
- Treat assessment as a way to **surface strengths and thinking**, not just sort students.
- Build supports early so they feel normal, not like labels.
- Keep asking: **Is this task measuring the learning goal, or just the student's ability to get around the barriers I created?**

Thank you